

Code of Conduct

Mission Statement

Our multidisciplinary team will design and build a portable, automated manufacturing system for custom, on-demand LEGO-style kits for Rockwell Automation. We are committed to fostering an environment of respect, honesty, open communication, professionalism, and accountability. Every team member will have an equal opportunity to contribute, learn, and be heard throughout the project.

Outside Obligations

We understand that everyone has responsibilities outside of the senior design project.

- Members should communicate conflicts that may affect meetings, deadlines, or assigned work as soon as reasonably possible.
- Outside responsibilities are understandable, but repeated conflicts should be communicated so the team can plan around them.
- If a member knows they will be unavailable for an extended period, they should inform the team **at least 24 hours in advance whenever reasonably possible**.
- If a member knows they will have a conflict with a scheduled meeting, they should notify the team **at least 2 hours before the meeting**.
- Unexpected circumstances should be communicated as soon as the member is able.
- The team will try to work around reasonable conflicts when possible.
- Different departmental schedules should be considered when scheduling meetings and assigning work.
- Outside obligations should not be used as a reason to consistently leave work unfinished without communicating with the team.

Team Roles

Team roles will be based on the **work to be completed, not on** authority or leadership.

Each member will have responsibilities related to the project, such as:

- Mechanical design and CAD
- Electrical/electronic systems
- Programming and controls
- Manufacturing/fabrication
- Testing and validation
- Research and documentation
- Project scheduling and organization
- Presentations and technical communication

Primary and Secondary Roles

- Each member should have a **primary role** based on their strengths, experience, area of study, or current project responsibilities.
- Each member should also have a **secondary area** where they can learn, assist, and develop experience outside of their primary role.
- The purpose of having secondary roles is to prevent members from becoming isolated within one area of the project and to help the team understand how the different disciplines work together.
- Members should be willing to **teach one another and share knowledge** when reasonably possible.
- Roles are not meant to prevent members from helping with other parts of the project.

Helping Other Team Members

Team members are **allowed and encouraged to help other members** with their assigned work when it is reasonable.

However, helping another member does **not** mean that the assisting member automatically becomes responsible for that person's entire assignment.

For example, a member may:

- Help troubleshoot a problem.
- Explain something they understand.

- Review another member's work.
- Help with calculations, CAD, programming, fabrication, or testing.
- Work together on a difficult task.
- Help another discipline understand how their portion of the system interacts with the rest of the project.

However, this should **not be taken advantage of**.

A member should not repeatedly rely on another teammate to complete work that they are responsible for. The person assigned to the task remains responsible for understanding and contributing to their portion of the work.

If a member needs substantial help with their assignment, they should communicate that to the team rather than silently shifting the workload to another member.

Other Duties

Other duties will be assigned based on the project's current needs, each member's workload, and members' skills or interests.

If a member finishes their assigned work while another part of the project needs attention, the team may discuss and assign additional work.

Methods of Communication

The Microsoft Teams and GroupMe **group chat will be the primary method of communication** for the team.

- Important project information should be communicated in the group chat so everyone has access to it.
- If GroupMe is used, updates should be posted in the corresponding channel that covers the topic of the update to keep messages organized and avoid confusion.
- Project decisions that affect the entire team should be communicated to the entire team rather than only discussed in a private conversation.
- Team members should respond to normal project-related messages within 24 hours whenever reasonably possible.
- If a response is needed sooner than 24 hours, the message should clearly state the expected response time.
- For urgent issues involving a deadline, meeting, safety concern, testing issue, or another member's work, members should respond as soon as reasonably possible and preferably within 4 hours.
- Members do not have to respond immediately if they are in class, working, sleeping, or handling another reasonable obligation.
- If someone expects to be unavailable for more than 24 hours, they should notify the team beforehand whenever possible.
- If an unexpected situation prevents communication, the member should notify the team as soon as they are able.
- Important messages should be acknowledged even if the member does not yet have a full response.
- An acknowledgment can be as simple as: "Received, no issues on my end." Or a simple sign, like a thumbs-up.
- If there is an issue, disagreement, or something that needs clarification, the member should communicate that rather than simply acknowledging the message.
- For urgent issues involving a deadline, meeting, safety concern, testing issue, or another member's work, members should respond as soon as possible and preferably within 4 hours.

- If someone expects to be unavailable for more than 24 hours, they should notify the team beforehand whenever possible.

Main Point of Contact

The team will establish a **primary point of contact for different types of external communication**.

This may include communication with:

- Rockwell Automation Sponsors
- Professors
- TAs
- Senior Design Coordinators
- Other external contacts

The point of contact may vary depending on the situation and does not represent authority over the rest of the team.

- Team members should avoid having multiple people independently send the same question or request to an external contact unless necessary, so messaging is reserved for the main point of contact.
- When an email response or important information is received from an external contact, the relevant information should be **shared with the rest of the team**.
- When appropriate, the team should be **CC'd on external email communication** so that members remain informed.
- Team members should not make commitments, promises, schedule changes, or major decisions on behalf of the entire team without first discussing them with the group unless immediate action is necessary.

The team may also use email, OneDrive, Microsoft Teams, or other platforms when they are better suited for specific project needs.

Scheduling

Because the team consists of multiple engineering disciplines, scheduling will not always be the same for everyone.

Meetings will be scheduled using the team's shared scheduling method, such as **When2Meet or a team calendar**.

- Members should keep their availability reasonably up to date.
- Meeting requests should normally be made at least 24 hours in advance when possible.

- If a meeting needs to be scheduled sooner than 24 hours, members should be given reasonable notice, and the team should try to accommodate conflicts.
- If a member cannot attend a scheduled meeting, they should notify the group at least 2 hours before the meeting whenever reasonably possible.
- If something unexpected happens within those 2 hours, communicate with the group as soon as possible.
- If a member misses a meeting, they should review the meeting notes and ask about anything they need to know within 24 hours.
- If an in-person meeting is not physically possible, the option of a virtual meeting will need to be requested to the team by that member within 2 hours before the meeting.

Dress Code

There is **no formal dress code for normal team meetings** unless the location or activity requires one.

Presentations

When doing presentations, the team is expected to **look uniform and professionally well-dressed**.

This does not necessarily mean everyone must wear the same clothing. However, the team should have a consistent and coordinated appearance.

Examples include:

- Similar colors or color palettes.
- Similar levels of formality.
- Professional or business-professional clothing.
- Coordinated shirts, polos, button-downs, blouses, slacks, skirts, or other appropriate professional clothing.
- A coordinated team shirt or **COE polo shirt**, when available.

The goal is for the team to look like **one team**, rather than several individuals who happened to be presenting together.

Sponsor or Professional Interactions

For Rockwell sponsor meetings, professional meetings, interviews, demonstrations, or other interactions in which the team represents the project, members should dress uniformly in business-casual attire.

A similar color palette or coordinated clothing is encouraged. It is also encouraged for each member to obtain a FAMU-FSU college of engineering polo.

For example, the team may agree beforehand to wear:

- Navy/black/white
- Black/gray
- School colors
- A team shirt with coordinated pants

Specific clothing choices can vary depending on the situation, but the team should make a reasonable effort to maintain a consistent, **professional appearance**.

For laboratory, manufacturing, or testing environments, members must also follow all required safety clothing and PPE requirements.

Attendance Policy

The team will meet **at least two times per week**, unless the team agrees that additional or fewer meetings are appropriate for the current stage of the project. Each team must attend one of the weekly meetings.

Suggested Weekly Structure

Meeting	Day	Time	Purpose
ME-focused meeting	T/Th	After SD	ME Senior Design requirements and project work
ECE/EE/CE-focused meeting	W	2:30 p.m - 3:30 p.m	ECE/EE/CE Senior Design requirements and project work
Mixed ME/ECE/EE/CE meeting	Friday	10:45 p.m - 11: 45a.m	Full-team coordination and system integration

The exact days and times will be determined based on team availability.

Weekly Meetings

The team will have **at least two opportunities to meet each week.**

The ME and ECE meetings allow members to handle department-specific Senior Design work and scheduling.

The mixed meeting allows the entire team to:

- Share progress.
- Discuss problems between disciplines.
- Coordinate mechanical and electrical work.
- Discuss system integration.
- Review project deadlines.
- Make decisions affecting the entire Rockwell project.
- Allow members who missed another meeting to catch up.
- Make sure the entire team remains aware of the project's current state.

The goal is for each member to have **at least two opportunities to participate in team meetings each week, with the mixed meeting serving as an important way for everyone to stay connected.**

If scheduling permits, the team may hold all three meetings in a given week.

If a Member Misses a Meeting

Missing one meeting does not automatically mean a member is not contributing.

Because another meeting may occur later in the week, a member who misses one meeting should use the next available meeting or mixed-team meeting to catch up.

If a member misses a meeting:

1. They should notify the team before (/after) the meeting whenever reasonably possible, preferred within 24 hours.
2. They should review what was discussed.
3. They should complete any responsibilities that were assigned to them.
4. They should ask questions about anything they do not understand.
5. If necessary, they should use the next team or mixed meeting to catch up.

Leaving Early

If an attendee knows they will need to leave early or have limited time for a meeting, they should notify the group **before the meeting begins**.

If something unexpected requires them to leave during the meeting, they should notify the group through the group chat or verbally before leaving when possible.

Leaving early does not automatically constitute an attendance problem, especially when the member communicated the limitation in advance.

Attendance Tracking

Attendance will be tracked through the team's meeting calendar, meeting notes, or another agreed-upon method.

The purpose of tracking attendance is to make sure the team knows who was present and what information may need to be communicated to someone who was absent.

Professional Meeting Behavior

During team meetings, sponsor meetings, presentations, and other professional settings, members should give their attention to whoever is speaking.

Members should:

- Remain quiet and respectful when someone else is speaking.
- Give team members their attention during discussions.
- Avoid unnecessary side conversations.
- Avoid unnecessary distractions.
- Come prepared when an agenda or assigned task requires preparation.
- Ask questions when clarification is needed.
- Allow others to finish their point before responding.

Phone Usage

Phones should generally be **muted during meetings**.

Unnecessary phone use, including scrolling through social media or other unrelated content, should be avoided during meetings.

If a member needs to take a call or send a message, especially for an emergency or important outside obligation, they should **excuse themselves and step away when possible**.

During:

- Rockwell sponsor meetings
- Presentations
- Design reviews
- Professional meetings
- Other formal interactions

phones and other unnecessary devices should be **put away and kept from making noise**. Please notify those outside of the meeting that you will be able to get back to them after the meeting, unless it is an emergency, then please inform the team and excuse yourself.

External Support

If the team cannot reasonably resolve an attendance, workload, communication, or participation issue internally, the team will communicate with the **professor, TA, or appropriate project contact**.

External support should be included when:

- A repeated attendance issue begins affecting the project.
- A member repeatedly fails to communicate.
- A workload problem cannot be resolved by the team.
- A disagreement between disciplines cannot reasonably be resolved.
- The team is unsure how a Senior Design requirement should be handled.

What is expected when we call in external help

- If it is the TAs...
- If it's the Professors...
- If other professionals outside sources

Communication & Professional Conduct

Because our project depends on everyone being able to work together, disagreements are expected, but disrespect is not.

- Everyone should have an opportunity to speak and contribute.
- Criticism should be directed toward the **idea, design, or work**, not the person.
- Members should be honest when they do not understand something or need help.
- Personal disagreements should not interfere with the project.
- Members should not intentionally embarrass, insult, threaten, or harass another member.
- If there is a disagreement, members should first try to address it directly and respectfully.
- If the disagreement involves different departmental requirements, the relevant requirements should be compared before deciding that one department's approach is correct.
- If the disagreement cannot be resolved, the team can discuss it together or seek help from the professor/TA.

Conflict Procedure

- If communicating about an issue over an electronic medium, give an indication of the issue before the meeting
- Try to keep conversations about conflicts to in-person meetings or Video calls
- Do not use never and always when referring to a member's actions
 - E.g., "Jack, you are always late to the mix meetings." Instead, do "Jack, you were late to the last two meetings"
- Address the behavior that is causing the issue, the resulting feelings, and the impact it has on the team.
 - "Jack, you were late two meetings and did not notify anyone. When you did that it made the team feel like you did not respect our time and you do not want to work with us. As result of your absence, the team had to do your part of the project to keep up"

Rockwell Project Conduct

Because this project is being completed for Rockwell Automation, the team understands that the project should be treated as a professional engineering project and not simply as a class assignment.

The team will:

- Represent the project and university professionally when communicating with Rockwell.
- Respect sponsor-provided information and any confidentiality requirements.
- Avoid sharing information, designs, data, or materials that the sponsor has indicated should not be shared.
- Be honest about the current state of the project.
- Clearly communicate when a design, test, or prototype has not been completed.
- Do not fabricate testing results, performance data, or project progress.
- Follow appropriate laboratory, fabrication, electrical, and machine safety requirements.
- Recognize that the final system requires mechanical, electrical, software, and automation components to work together.

If a sponsor requirement conflicts with a course or departmental requirement, the team should discuss the conflict and, when necessary, seek clarification from the appropriate professor, TA, or Rockwell project contact rather than making assumptions.

Team Assignment vs. Individual Assignment

The default expectation is that senior design work will be completed as a **team assignment** unless the professor or project requirements state otherwise.

Because this is a **multi-disciplinary Senior Design project**, there may be situations where ME and ECE have different requirements for what must be included in a report, presentation, design review, or other deliverable.

However, there may be situations where a contribution needs to be treated as an individual responsibility.

A task may be considered an **individual assignment** when:

- The team specifically assigns the task to one member.
- The task requires a specific member's role or expertise.
- The member agrees to take responsibility for completing that task.
- The task is assigned as an individual deliverable by the professor, TA, or sponsor.

Handling Different Department Requirements

When ME and ECE have different requirements for the same assignment:

1. The team should first compare the rubrics and requirements from both departments.
2. The team should identify the requirements that overlap.
3. The team should identify the requirements that are unique to each department.
4. The team should attempt to create one deliverable that satisfies the requirements of both departments.
5. If one document cannot reasonably satisfy both sets of requirements, the team may create separate versions of the work.
6. For example, if both departments require a technical report but have different formatting, analysis, or documentation requirements, the team should first create the common technical content and then adjust the appropriate sections to satisfy each department.

7. If necessary, the team may produce two versions of a paper, report, presentation, or other deliverable, with each version conforming to the Senior Design requirements of the appropriate department.
8. The technical information should remain consistent between versions unless a department specifically requires different information.
9. The goal is to satisfy both sets of requirements while maintaining one coherent project.

What Counts as a Contribution?

A contribution can include:

- Completing an assigned design or analysis.
- Performing research.
- Creating CAD models or drawings.
- Writing or modifying code.
- Designing electrical or control systems.
- Building or fabricating a component.
- Performing testing or collecting data.
- Completing calculations or simulations.
- Integrating mechanical, electrical, and software components.
- Writing a section of a report.
- Creating presentation material.
- Documenting project decisions or results.
- Troubleshooting system problems.
- Completing another task agreed upon by the team.
- Simply being present at a meeting does not automatically count as completing a contribution.

When a Team Assignment Becomes an Individual Issue

If a member is not contributing to an assigned team responsibility, the team should first communicate with that member directly.

For example:

"You were assigned this portion of the project, and we noticed it has not been completed. Is there something preventing you from finishing it?"

The purpose is to understand the problem before assuming the member is unwilling to contribute.

- **If the problem continues:**
- **The team will communicate the concern to the member.**
- **The team will determine whether the responsibility or deadline needs to be adjusted.**
- **The team will document the agreed-upon responsibility and deadline.**
- **If the member still does not contribute or communicate, the team may contact the professor or TA for guidance.**

Communicating With the Instructor

The team should **not immediately report a teammate for a single missed task or meeting.**

However, if a member repeatedly does not contribute after reasonable attempts to communicate with them, the team may communicate the situation to the professor/TA.

The team should provide **specific information**, such as:

- What task was assigned?
- When it was assigned.
- What deadline was agreed upon?
- What communication attempts were made?
- What work was or was not completed.
- How the lack of contribution affected the project.

The purpose is to give the instructor an accurate understanding of the situation rather than simply saying that someone "isn't doing anything."

Accountability

Everyone is expected to take responsibility for their assigned work.

If a member realizes they cannot complete something, **asking for help or communicating early is better than saying nothing, and it is your responsibility.**

When problems occur, the team should first try to solve them internally. If the problem continues or begins to significantly affect the project, the professor or TA should be contacted.

Serious issues involving safety, harassment, academic misconduct, or other university requirements may be brought to the appropriate authority immediately.

At the end of the day, we work as a team and will bear the responsibilities for both failures and successes as a team.

Statement of Understanding

By signing this Code of Conduct, I acknowledge that I have read and understand the expectations established by the team.

I understand that this document is meant to help the team communicate, divide work fairly, handle conflicts, and remain accountable throughout the senior design project.

I understand that everyone has responsibilities outside of this project and that reasonable conflicts can happen. I agree that **communication is expected when those conflicts affect the team.**

I also understand that being part of a team means contributing to the project, respecting other members, and communicating when I need help.

By signing below, I agree to make a effort to follow this Code of Conduct and contribute to the success of the team.

Team Member	Signature	Date
Emilee Strom		09/09/2026
James Riordan		09/09/2026
Shamil Jones		September 10, 2026
Ravion Hyatt		Sept 10 th , 2026
Wole Senat		Sept 11 th , 2026
Alan Bernal		Sept 11 th , 2026

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AI Use Acknowledgment

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